

Greed

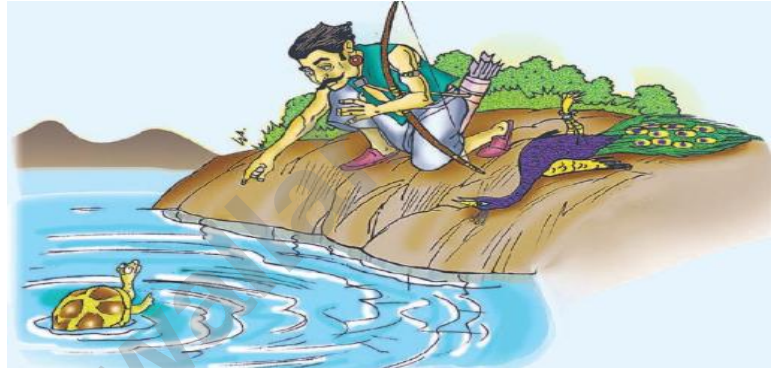
A TURTLE who lived in a lake and a peacock who lived on a tree on the **banks** of the lake became good friends. One day as the two of them were chatting, a hunter **crept up** and **ensnared** the peacock in a net.

The turtle **begged** the hunter to release his friend.

"Why should I release this handsome bird?" **retorted** the hunter. "He'll **fetch** me a good price in the market!"

"I'll give you a pearl for his freedom," said the turtle. "Wait here."

He **dived** into the lake and after some time came back with a pearl that made the hunter's eyes **pop out** in **astonishment**. It was of the finest quality. The hunter at once released the peacock, and went away happily with the pearl.



Two days later he was back. The turtle had just come out of the lake and when he saw the man **approaching**, **braced** himself for trouble.

"The pearl you gave me is no doubt valuable," said the hunter, "but its value would become still greater if I had a matching one to set in a pair of earrings. Get me another pearl, otherwise...!" His voice took on a **menacing** tone.

"All right, all right," said the turtle. "Give me the pearl I gave you and I'll try to find another that matches it."

The hunter gave him the pearl, and the turtle got back into the water.

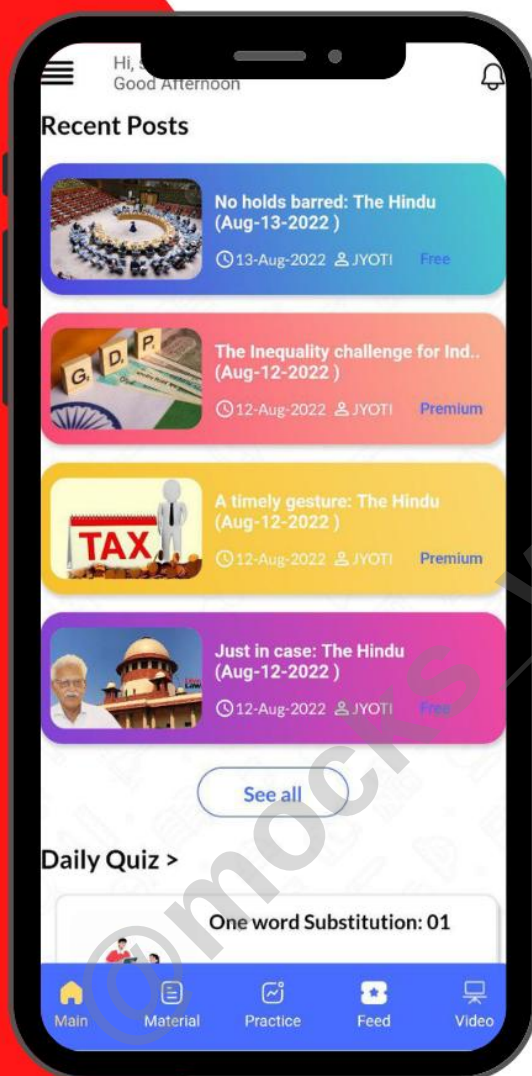
"How long will you take?" asked the hunter.

"**Perhaps** forever," said the turtle. "You see, my friend and I knew you would return and I **persuaded** him to move to another tree deep in the forest. I don't have to worry about him any more!"

And with that, the turtle disappeared into the water, leaving the hunter shocked and **dismayed**.

Vocabulary

1. **Bank** (noun) – shore, edge, riverside, embankment, waterfront किनारा
2. **Creep up** (phrasal verb) – sneak, tiptoe, crawl, edge, slink धीरे से आना / दबे पांव आना
3. **Ensnare** (verb) – trap, capture, entangle, net, ensnare फँसाना
4. **Beg** (verb) – plead, implore, beseech, entreat, request विनती करना
5. **Retort** (verb) – reply, respond, counter, answer back, snap कहकर उत्तर देना / पलटकर जवाब देना
6. **Fetch** (verb) – bring, get, retrieve, obtain, collect लाना / प्राप्त करना
7. **Dive** (verb) – plunge, submerge, descend, dip, immerse गोताखोरी करना / पानी में उतरना
8. **Pop out** (phrasal verb) – bulge, protrude, stick out, emerge, jump out उभर आना / बाहर निकल आना
9. **Astonishment** (noun) – amazement, surprise, wonder, awe, disbelief आश्चर्य
10. **Approach** (verb) – come near, advance, move forward, reach, draw close निकट आना / पास आना
11. **Brace** (verb) – prepare, steady, fortify, support, steel oneself तैयार होना / कमर कसना
12. **Menacing** (adjective) – threatening, intimidating, alarming, ominous, hostile धमकी भरा / डरावना
13. **Perhaps** (adverb) – maybe, possibly, conceivably, perchance, feasibly शायद
14. **Persuade** (verb) – convince, coax, influence, urge, prompt राज़ी करना / मनाना
15. **Dismay** (verb) – discourage, shock, upset, dishearten, bewilder हताश करना / चकित करना



Learn Vocabulary Through Reading Articles

English Madhyam